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THE 2026–2030 BITCOIN CYCLE ROADMAP

Every price target. Every timeline. The data behind each one.

5 Years
of projections

4 Phases
mapped with data

\$35K–\$200K
full price range

"The stuff the \$750B bank will publish in 6 months."

Based on halving cycle data from 2012, 2016, 2020, and 2024.

February 2026 | For educational purposes only. Not financial advice.

THE CYCLE MATH

You saw the receipts. \$100K call (2024) ✓. October 2025 peak call ✓. Bear market call (Nov 2025) ✓. Now here's the full roadmap.

Every Bitcoin cycle follows a rhythm anchored to the halving. Returns diminish each cycle, but the structure hasn't broken once.

HALVING	DATE	DAYS TO PEAK	PRIOR BEAR BOTTOM	CYCLE PEAK	GAIN (Bottom→Peak)
2012	Nov 2012	~370	\$2 (2011)	\$1,100	+54,900%
2016	Jul 2016	~518	\$150 (2015)	\$19,700	+13,000%
2020	May 2020	~550	\$3,100 (2018)	\$69,000	+2,125%
2024	Apr 2024	~535	\$15,500 (2022)	\$126,000	+713%

KEY OBSERVATIONS

- Returns diminish as market cap grows: 54,900% → 13,000% → 2,125% → 713%
- Days to peak remarkably consistent: 370 → 518 → 550 → 535
- First cycle where BTC hit ATH BEFORE the halving (ETF-driven)
- Oct 2025 peak at ~535 days post-halving fits the pattern exactly

THE MECHANICAL FORMULA

GIVEN HALVING DATE H:	
Estimated Peak	H + 18 months
Estimated Bottom	H + 30 months
DCA Start Window	H + 30 months
Primary Accumulation	H + 30m → H + 48m

This formula has called the approximate peak and bottom of every cycle since 2012. Institutions compress the magnitude. They don't break the timing.

WHERE WE ARE NOW — FEBRUARY 2026

METRIC	VALUE
Cycle High	\$126,272 (Oct 6, 2025)
Current Price	~\$67,000
Drawdown From Peak	-52% (and counting)
Days Post-Halving	~660
ETF Outflows	~100,000 BTC since Oct 2025

Avg ETF Entry Price	~\$90,000 (underwater)
Fear & Greed Index	Extreme Fear

BEAR MARKET DRAWDOWN HISTORY

CYCLE	PEAK	BOTTOM	DRAWDOWN
2011	\$31	\$2	-93%
2014-15	\$1,100	\$150	-86%
2018	\$19,700	\$3,100	-84%
2022	\$69,000	\$15,500	-77%
2025-26?	\$126,000	???	-52% so far

The pattern: Drawdowns get shallower: -93% → -86% → -84% → -77%. Institutional adoption raises the floor. But the floor is still far down.

THE LIQUIDITY PROBLEM: 2020 vs. 2026

FACTOR	2020	2026
M2 Money Printing	+25% (\$3.9T) in one year	+15% over 5 years combined
Stimulus	\$2,400/person + \$25K PPP loans	None
Fed Policy	Cutting + printing	Uncertain / hawkish
ETFs	Did not exist	Net sellers
Prior Setup	-84% bear recovery	Cooling from euphoria

2020 had 4 simultaneous tailwinds. In 2026, all 4 are absent or reversed.

WHAT STANDARD CHARTERED IS SAYING

Standard Chartered has downgraded Bitcoin 3 times in 5 months:

	STANDARD CHARTERED	MY PROJECTION
2026 Bottom	\$50,000	\$35,000–\$50,000
2026 EOY	\$100,000	Premature. Recovery hasn't started.
Long-Term	\$500K by 2030	~\$200K by 2029. Diminishing returns says no.
Track Record	3 downgrades in 5 months	\$100K call ✓ Oct peak ✓ Bear market ✓

Their models react to price. The cycle math projects it. They'll downgrade again.

PHASE 1

THE BOTTOM

\$35K–\$50K | Q4 2026

THE MATH BEHIND THE TARGET

Projecting the diminishing drawdown trend forward:

SCENARIO	DRAWDOWN	BOTTOM	BASIS
Conservative	-60%	~\$50,000	Matches StanChart call
Base Case	-67%	~\$41,600	Midpoint of trend
Aggressive	-72%	~\$35,300	Closer to 2022 (-77%)

Timing: H + 30 months = April 2024 + 30m = **October 2026**. The drawdown pattern and timing pattern converge on Q4 2026.

HOW TO KNOW THE BOTTOM IS ACTUALLY IN

Don't try to catch the exact bottom. Watch for this confluence:

- **50-Week MA Behavior** — BTC drops well below, then reclaims. Bottom formed 15-30% below in 2018/2022.
- **Weekly RSI Below 30** — Deeply oversold on weekly. Only happens at major cycle bottoms.
- **Capitulation Volume Spike** — Final panic flush. High volume + sharp drop + immediate reversal.
- **Fear & Greed Sustained Below 15** — Not one day. Sustained extreme fear for 2+ weeks = capitulation.
- **Miner Capitulation** — Hash ribbons compress/invert. Weakest hands done selling.

No single signal confirms the bottom. When 3+ align, that's your window.

PHASE 2

ACCUMULATION PLAYBOOK

Oct 2026 – Apr 2028 | Your DCA Framework

You don't need the exact bottom. You need a rules-based system that puts you in position while everyone else is frozen.

STEP 1: SET YOUR TOTAL ALLOCATION

Pick your total amount for 12-18 months. Keep emergency fund separate. DCA money = long horizon.

STEP 2: FRONT-LOAD YOUR SIZING

Biggest gains come from buying earliest. Don't spread evenly:

MONTHS	ALLOCATION	EXAMPLE (\$25K)	EXAMPLE (\$50K)
Months 1–3	40%	\$10,000	\$20,000
Months 4–6	30%	\$7,500	\$15,000

Months 7–9	20%	\$5,000	\$10,000
Months 10–12	10%	\$2,500	\$5,000

STEP 3: PRICE-AWARE BOOSTERS (Optional)

Layer small increases when value improves:

TRIGGER	BOOST
BTC drops -20% from rolling 200-day high	+25%
Fear & Greed Index below 25	+25%
Macro spike (VIX > 25 or crypto vol spike)	+25%
MAXIMUM per month	+50% cap

Kill-Switch: BTC closes >+40% above 200-day MA → stop boosts, stick to base schedule.

STEP 4: WHAT TO BUY

3 bear market bottoms analyzed (2015, 2018, 2022). Same result every time:

TIER	2018–2021	2022–2025	BUSTS
Top 25	+1,846%	+199%	0
Ranks 26-50	+435%	+91%	0
Ranks 51-75	+254%	-5%	7
Ranks 76-100	+351%	-27%	9

Rule: First 6 months = 100% BTC (up to 20% ETH). Next 6-12 months = diversify 20-30% into top-25 alts once BTC trends up weekly. Skip 51-100. **No leverage.**

PHASE 3

THE 2028 HALVING + BULL RUN

April 2028 – Q4 2029 | Target: ~\$200K

The next halving: April 2028. Every halving preceded a bull run:

HALVING	DAYS TO PEAK	PEAK
2012	~370 days	Nov 2013
2016	~518 days	Dec 2017
2020	~550 days	Nov 2021
2024	~535 days	Oct 2025
2028 (proj.)	~500–550 days	Q3–Q4 2029

THE \$200K TARGET — THE MATH

Gains from each bear bottom to the next cycle peak:

BEAR BOTTOM	NEXT PEAK	GAIN
\$2 (2011)	\$1,100 (2013)	+54,900%
\$150 (2015)	\$19,700 (2017)	+13,000%
\$3,100 (2018)	\$69,000 (2021)	+2,125%
\$15,500 (2022)	\$126,000 (2025)	+713%
\$35K–\$50K (2026?)	??? (2029)	+200–400%

If bottom = \$40K and gain = 300% → \$160K | 400% → \$200K

If bottom = \$50K and gain = 200% → \$150K | 300% → \$200K

\$200K sits in the middle of every reasonable scenario. Not a moonshot — the diminishing returns curve continuing.

StanChart says \$500K by 2030. That needs 10x in 4 years. The curve went from +54,900% to +713% across 4 cycles. A 10x reverses the trend. That target will be downgraded.

PHASE 4

THE EXIT PLAYBOOK

2029 Peak → 2030 Bear | TIME is the primary signal

The most reliable exit signal across all 4 cycles has been **TIME** — not price targets, not indicators, not sentiment. The halving-to-peak window of 500–550 days has been more accurate than any other signal.

THE TIME-BASED EXIT FRAMEWORK

2028 halving (April) + 500–550 days = **Q3–Q4 2029**. This is when you exit, regardless of how bullish it feels:

TIMING	ACTION	WHY
H + 12 months (Apr 2029)	Sell 25%	Bull run maturing. First profits locked.
H + 15 months (Jul 2029)	Sell 25%	Approaching the 500-day peak window.
H + 18 months (Oct 2029)	Sell 25%	Peak window. Every cycle topped here.
Keep 25%	Hold forever	"Moon bag" for future cycles.

SECONDARY CONFIRMATION SIGNALS

Time is primary. These are secondary confirmations:

- **Weekly RSI above 80** — Historically marks blow-off top zone
- **Funding highly positive 2+ weeks** — Everyone leveraged long = top
- **New ATH achieved** — Start trims immediately

THE EUPHORIA CHECKLIST

When 3+ appear alongside the time window, sell without hesitation:

- Friends/family asking what crypto to buy
- Crypto dominating mainstream news
- "This time is different" narrative everywhere
- You feel like a genius
- Insane price predictions normalized (\$1M+)
- People quitting jobs to trade crypto

Projection: bear market begins 2030, potentially revisiting \$100K. If you executed the time-based exit, profits are already secured.

You don't need to sell the top. You need to sell before the bottom.

THE FULL TIMELINE

Screenshot this. Bookmark it. We'll revisit.

YEAR	PHASE	PRICE RANGE	ACTION
2026	BEAR MARKET	\$35K–\$50K bottom Q4	Preserve capital. Map DCA levels.
2027	ACCUMULATION	\$35K–\$70K	DCA playbook. 40/30/20/10 split.
2028	HALVING (April)	\$70K–\$120K	Hold and ride. Stop boosts at +40% above 200D MA.
2029	PEAK (Q3–Q4)	~\$200K	Time-based exit. 25% at H+12/15/18m.
2030	BEAR RESETS	Revisit ~\$100K	Remaining profits. Cycle resets.

Cycles don't care about press releases. They haven't broken once. The question isn't IF. It's whether you're positioned.

THIS IS THE STATIC ROADMAP. MY DISCORD IS THE LIVE GPS.

Every DCA entry. Every booster trigger. Every exit call. With timestamps.

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